Use ChatGPT to Get Your "What Can Mom Keep?" Questions Ready

Four prompts to list what Mom owns, sort what you've been told from what you're assuming, find the questions nobody has asked yet, and match each question to the professional who can answer it.

Where you are

Mom is in care and the monthly cost is coming out of her savings. Nobody has told you what happens to the house, the accounts, or Dad's share, and you've heard different things from different people.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names and account numbers removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not give legal, financial, or Medicaid eligibility advice, and the rules vary by state. Bring those questions to the right professional.

What you'll have at the end

You have one page showing what she owns and how it's owned, what you've actually been told and by whom, and the questions a professional still has to answer.

A one-page list: What Mom owns and how it's owned, What we've been told (and by whom), What we're assuming, and Questions to bring to a professional.

Before you start

- A rough list of what Mom owns: the home, savings, retirement accounts, insurance, and anything else of value.
- Whose name is on each one, as best you know.
- Anything you've been told so far about what she can keep, and who said it. You don't need everything.

PROMPT 1

List what Mom owns, and how it's owned

WHY THIS MATTERS

What a parent may be able to keep depends on the assets, the family's circumstances, the state's rules, and planning already in place. Nobody can start on that question without a plain list of what there is and whose name is on it.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Your rough list of what she owns, with whatever you know about ownership. Don't tidy it up.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I know about what my mother owns:

> [PASTE YOUR LIST]
>
> Using only what I've written, make a table with four columns: WHAT IT IS, WHOSE NAME IS ON IT (hers alone, joint, a trust, or not sure), NAMED BENEFICIARY IF ANY, and WHERE THE PAPERWORK IS. Where I didn't say, write "not sure" so I can see the blank. Do not tell me how Medicaid treats any item, and do not label anything as protected, exempt, or countable.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A plain inventory with the blanks showing, and no verdicts.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Fill in the "not sure" boxes you can settle with a statement, a deed, or a phone call.

PROMPT 2

Sort what you've been told from what you're assuming

WHY THIS MATTERS

Families hear a lot about what has to be spent and what happens to the house. Some of it came from someone who knows their situation. Much of it didn't. Writing down who said what keeps a general remark from being treated as an answer.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything you currently believe about what Mom can keep, and where you heard each thing.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I currently believe about what my mother can keep if she needs Medicaid, and where I heard each thing:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Sort these into three lists: TOLD TO US BY A PROFESSIONAL WHO KNOWS HER SITUATION (with who and when), HEARD OR READ SOMEWHERE GENERAL, and OUR OWN ASSUMPTION. Do not tell me whether any of them is correct. Medicaid rules vary by state and depend on the facts, so mark every item in the second and third lists "to confirm."

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

How short the first list is. Everything else is a question, not an answer.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Carry the “to confirm” items into the last prompt.

PROMPT 3

Find the questions nobody has asked yet

WHY THIS MATTERS

Qualifying for Medicaid now and what may come up later are different questions. It’s common to ask about the first and never get to the second.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The results of the first two prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is what I’ve organized so far about my mother’s situation:
>
> [PASTE THE RESULTS OF PROMPTS 1 AND 2]
>
> Based only on this, which of these areas have I said nothing about: the home, a spouse’s housing, income and assets, jointly owned property, beneficiary designations, trusts, insurance, and estate recovery? List each gap as a question I could ask a professional. Do not answer the questions and do not explain the rules.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

The areas you haven’t raised with anyone yet.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Add those questions to your list.

PROMPT 4

Match each question to who can answer it

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some questions belong to a Medicaid planner, some to an elder law attorney, some to a licensed financial professional, and some only the family can answer. Knowing which is which is the point of this guide.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Everything from the first three prompts.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is everything I've gathered about what my mother owns and what we've been told:
>
> [PASTE EVERYTHING FROM PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Give me one page with four headings: WHAT MOM OWNS AND HOW IT'S OWNED, WHAT WE'VE BEEN TOLD (AND BY WHOM), WHAT WE'RE ASSUMING, and QUESTIONS TO BRING TO A PROFESSIONAL. Under the last heading, mark each question with who should answer it: the family, a Medicaid planner, an elder law attorney, a licensed financial professional, or not sure. Do not answer the legal or financial questions, and do not suggest moving, transferring, retitling, or spending anything.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

One page you could hand to a professional and have them understand where things stand.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Keep the page. It's the start of the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've listed what Mom owns and the questions you still have. The planning interview walks you through your family's situation step by step so nothing important is left out, and turns your answers into a free planning report you can bring to a professional.

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